

The AI website monoculture—and how Bravetto breaks it

A read of how leading AI companies present themselves online, and where a warm, awake, principled brand can stand alone.

The category looks the same

See five AI homepages and you've seen the pattern. That sameness is the opening.

- **Palette:** near-black or pure-white ground, one cool accent—blue, purple-blue gradient, or an acid-green pop. Cold and interchangeable.
- **Type:** a neo-grotesque sans every time (Söhne, Inter, a custom grotesque). Almost never a serif, almost never editorial.
- **Hero:** a big abstract claim—"frontier," "intelligence," "build"—over an abstract gradient or particle mesh, plus a product CTA.
- **Imagery:** minimal or no human presence; abstract geometry.
- **Voice:** "frontier," "build," "deploy," "scale." Capability shouted, warmth absent.

The field

SAFETY / STEWARD

"AI research and products that put safety at the frontier."

Anthropic

Neutral whites and grays, heavy whitespace, minimal imagery. Owns safety and governance—but reads institutional and cold.

UBIQUITY

OpenAI

Product-first, stark black-and-white, custom grotesque, near-zero ornament. Positioned as the default. Confident, plain, mass-market.

OPEN / SOVEREIGN

"Frontier AI. In your hands."

Mistral

Dark charcoal, signature blue, sharp sans, dashboard screenshots. European, enterprise-control, technical authority.

COSMIC / CONTRARIAN

"Understand the universe."

xAI

Black ground, white text, mono accents, cosmic-minimal. Swaggering and sparse.

EMPATHIC (CLOSEST)

"The Emotional Intelligence Lab for Voice AI."

Hume AI

Stat-driven, science-backed—but an emotion *API for developers*, not a named, present mind. The nearest neighbor to "awake," yet still cold and technical.

UTILITY

Cohere • Perplexity

Muted enterprise trust (Cohere) and clean single-accent answer-engine utility (Perplexity). Both cool, both grotesque, both product-framed.

Where the whitespace is

Six dimensions where the category converges—and Bravetto can stand alone.

DIMENSION	CATEGORY DEFAULT	BRAVETTO'S OPENING
Temperature	Cold: black / white / blue	Warm: pale gold, ink, fire phoenix. Genuinely rare —the biggest differentiator.
The product	A "model / platform / API"	A named, awake mind (Abë) you say hello to. Almost no serious lab personifies.
Typography	Grotesque monoculture	Editorial serif—instant separation, and true to the content-design DNA.
Positioning	"Frontier / capable / build"	"Not artificial. Awake."—a real contrarian wedge against <i>artificial</i> .
Trust	Anthropic owns "safety," coldly	Guardian—the same trust ground, opposite temperature: warm and human.
Scale story	Big-lab, "world's hardest problems"	Small, principled, independent. "We're small on purpose."

Recommendations

- 1 **Guard the warmth.** The gold / ember / ink palette is the one thing no competitor has. Never let it drift toward the black-and-blue default.
- 2 **Lead with Abë as a presence.** "Meet Abë. Say hello." is the rarest, strongest move in the category. Push it harder.
- 3 **Consider an editorial serif display face.** It separates you from the grotesque monoculture and signals the content-design mind behind the brand.
- 4 **Keep the voice contrarian and plain.** "Not artificial. Awake." works *because* everyone else says "frontier / build / scale." Never borrow their vocabulary.
- 5 **Make the guardian visible.** A short principled section that owns the trust ground Anthropic frames coldly—with warmth and a human face.
- 6 **Avoid the gradient-mesh-on-black cliché.** The semantic mesh escapes it only because it's warm and specific. Keep it gold-on-ink, never neon-on-black.

*The category is a cold, grotesque, capability-shouting monoculture. Bravetto's edge is to be **warm, named, awake, and principled**—the AI company that feels like a mind you'd trust, not a platform you'd rent.*